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Overseas Card Transaction Fees

Transactions made overseas or through overseas-based online merchants (including refunds and reversals) are subject to foreign transaction fees of up to 3.25%. This includes the bank’s administrative fees and charges imposed by the card associations (Visa/Mastercard/American Express/UnionPay).

Part of: [Guides](#) > [Go Travel with DBS](#), [Go Shopping with DBS](#)

Related articles

- [Enable/Disable Card for Overseas Use](#)
- [Transact & Withdraw in Foreign Currency Overseas](#)

Foreign Currency Retail Transaction

- For American Express, Mastercard and Visa Cards:
 - Transactions in US Dollar (USD) are converted directly to Singapore Dollar (SGD).
 - Transactions in other foreign currencies are first converted to USD, then converted to SGD.
- For UnionPay Cards:
 - Transactions in USD, Chinese Yuan (CNY) and Brunei Dollar (BND) are converted directly to SGD.
 - Transactions in other foreign currencies are first converted to USD, then converted to SGD.
- Exchange rates are determined by the respective card associations (American Express, Mastercard, Visa and UnionPay).
- Exchange rates may differ from the rate on your purchase date due to market fluctuations.

Foreign Currency Transaction Fees	American Express / Mastercard / Visa Cards	UnionPay Cards
Administrative fee charged by respective card associations	1.00%	0.60%
Administrative fee charged by bank	2.25%	2.65%
Total administrative fee on top of the prevailing foreign exchange rate determined by respective card associations	3.25%	3.25%

- Foreign currency transaction fees are applicable to all foreign currency transactions, **including purchases, refunds and reversals.**
- Foreign currency transactions fees are applied on the converted SGD amount at the time of processing.
- Refund and reversal amounts may differ from the original transaction amount due to exchange rate fluctuations and the applicable administrative fees charged by the respective card associations and the Bank, at the time of processing of the refund / reversal transaction.

For more information on Foreign Currency transaction fees, please click [here](#).

Do you need any help?

Dynamic Currency Conversion (DCC)

Dynamic Currency Conversion (DCC) Transaction Fees	Credit Cards (Mastercard/Visa)	Debit Cards (Mastercard/Visa)
Administrative fee charged by respective card associations	1.00%	1.00%
Administrative fee charged by bank	-	1.80%
Total administrative fee on top of the prevailing foreign exchange rate determined by respective card associations	1.00%	2.80%

- DCC transaction fees are applicable to all DCC transactions, **including purchases, refunds and reversals.**
- DCC transaction fees are applied on the converted SGD amount at the time of processing.
- Refund and reversal amounts may differ from the original transaction amount due to exchange rate fluctuations and applicable administrative fees charged by the respective card associations, at the time of processing of the refund / reversal transaction.

For more information on DCC fees, please click [here](#).

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

[Foreign Currency transaction fees](#)

What fees apply to foreign currency transactions on credit/debit cards?

Foreign currency transactions are subject to fees of 3.25% on the converted Singapore Dollar (SGD) amount. Details of the fees illustrated in the table below.

Foreign Currency Transaction Fees	American Express / Mastercard / Visa Cards	UnionPay Cards
Administrative fee charged by respective card associations	1.00%	0.60%
Administrative fee charged by bank	2.25%	2.65%
Total administrative fee on top of the prevailing foreign exchange rate determined by respective card associations	3.25%	3.25%

These administrative fees apply to all foreign currency transactions, **including purchases, refunds and reversals.**

How are foreign currency transactions converted?

Foreign currency transactions are converted to SGD using exchange rates determined by the respective card associations (American Express, Mastercard, Visa and UnionPay).

What exchange rate is used?

The exchange rate is determined by the respective card associations (American Express, Mastercard, Visa and UnionPay) based on the prevailing exchange rate at the time of conversion. This may differ from the exchange rate on the transaction date, due to market fluctuations.

When is my foreign currency transaction converted to SGD?

Transactions are typically converted when they are processed by the respective card association (American Express, Mastercard, Visa and UnionPay), which may be a few days after the purchase date.

Are fees charged on both the purchase and the refund/reversal?

Yes. Each transaction (purchases, refund or reversal) is processed separately. This means that the applicable foreign currency transaction fees are charged both when the sales transaction is made and when it is refunded/reversed.

Why is the refund amount different from the original charge?

Refund/reversal amounts may differ from the original amount charge due to the following reasons:

- Exchange rate fluctuations between purchase and refund/reversal processing date.
- Applicable foreign currency transaction fees charged on both transactions at time of processing.

Why does the exchange rate on my foreign currency transaction differ from what I see online?

These exchange rates are determined by the respective card associations and (American Express, Mastercard, Visa and UnionPay) may differ from publicly available exchange rates (e.g. online sources) as they are determined at the time of processing (not point of purchase).

Does this apply to online overseas transactions as well?

Yes. These foreign currency transaction fees and exchange rates apply to both:

- In-store overseas purchases
- Online transactions charged in foreign currencies

Dynamic Currency Conversion (DCC)

What is Dynamic Currency Conversion (DCC)?

Do you need any help?

DCC is a service offered by some overseas merchants or websites that allows your purchase to be

Dynamic Currency Conversion (DCC) Transaction Fees	Credit Cards (Mastercard/Visa)	Debit Cards (Mastercard/Visa)
Administrative fee charged by respective card associations	1.00%	1.00%
Administrative fee charged by bank	-	1.80%
Total administrative fee on top of the prevailing foreign exchange rate determined by respective card associations	1.00%	2.80%

These fees apply to all DCC transactions (including purchases, refunds and reversals). As refunds/reversals are processed as separate transactions, fees apply to both the original transaction and the refunded/reversed transaction.

What exchange rate is used?

The exchange rate is determined by the overseas merchant or their DCC service provider, and not by the Bank or the respective card association.

Are fees charged for both the purchase and the refund?

Yes. Each transaction (purchase, refund or reversal) is processed separately. This means that the applicable DCC transaction fees are charged both when the sales transaction is made and when it is refunded/reversed.

Why is the DCC refund amount different from the original charge?

Refund/reversal amounts may differ from the original amount charge due to the following reasons:

- Exchange rate fluctuations between purchase and refund/reversal processing dates;
- Exchange rates set by the overseas merchant or their DCC service provider; or
- Applicable DCC fees charged on both transactions at time of processing

As processing dates and rates may differ, the refunded/reversed amount may be higher or lower than the original charge.

How do I select to perform the transaction in DCC or local currency?

You will usually be given a choice at the point of payment at overseas merchants with DCC service.

What will I see for DCC transactions on my statement?

For DCC transactions, your statement will show the final SGD amount charged, inclusive of the total DCC administrative fee.



More information

- Read more on [DBS Debit Card Charges](#) or [DBS Credit Card Charges](#).

Was this information useful?

Yes

No

DBS Help and Support

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Guides

- [Security Guide on Scams and Fraud Attempts](#)
- [Your Guide to Card Replacement](#)

Awards

- Asia’s Safest Bank, 2009 – 2023, Global Finance
- Best Bank in the World 2022, Global Finance
- World's Best Bank 2021, Euromoney
- Best Bank in the World 2020, Global Finance
- World's Best Bank 2019, Euromoney
- Global Bank of the Year 2018, The Banker

